

SANSEVIERIA

to 4ft (1.2m) long, banded horizontally with pale green and yellow. Occasionally bears racemes of tubular, 6-lobed, green flowers. Z11–12 (min. 55°F/13°C). **‘Golden Hahnii’** illus. p.476. **‘Hahnii’** illus. p.475. **‘Laurentii’** illus. p.476.

SANTOLINA

ASTERACEAE/COMPOSITAE

Genus of evergreen, summer-flowering shrubs, grown for their aromatic foliage and their buttonlike flower heads. Fully hardy. Needs sun and not too rich, well-drained soil. Cut off old flower heads and reduce long shoots in fall. Cut straggly plants back hard each spring. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer.

S. chamaecyparissus, syn. *S. incana* (Cotton lavender, Lavender cotton). Evergreen, rounded, dense shrub. H 2½ft (75cm), S 3ft (1m). Shoots are covered with woolly, white growth, and narrowly oblong, finely toothed leaves are also white. Bears bright yellow flower heads in mid- and late summer. Z6–9. **‘Lambrook Silver’** has silver-gray leaves. **‘Lemon Queen’**, H and S 2ft (60cm) has a compact habit and lemon-yellow flower heads.

S. incana. See *S. chamaecyparissus*. **S. neapolitana**. See *S. pinnata* subsp. *neapolitana*.

S. pinnata. Evergreen shrub, mainly grown as **subsp. neapolitana** (syn. *S. neapolitana*), which has a rounded, bushy habit. H 2½ft (75cm), S 3ft (1m). In midsummer, slender flower stems bear a head of lemon-yellow flowers, among feathery, deeply cut, gray-green foliage. **subsp. neapolitana ‘Sulphurea’** illus. p.159. Z7–10

S. rosmarinifolia, syn. *S. virens* (Holy flax). Evergreen, bushy, dense shrub. H 2ft (60cm), S 3ft (1m). Has finely cut, bright green leaves. Each slender stem bears a head of bright yellow flowers in midsummer. Z6–9. **‘Lemon Fizz’** has striking, yellow-green foliage.

subsp. rosmarinifolia ‘Primrose Gem’ has pale yellow flower heads. **S. virens**. See *S. rosmarinifolia*.

Sanvitalia **AZTEC GOLD of gardens.** See *Melampodium montanum* **AZTEC GOLD** (‘Starbini’).

SAPONARIA

Soapwort

CARYOPHYLLACEAE

Genus of summer-flowering annuals and perennials, grown for their abundant flowers, usually in shades of pink. Good for rock gardens, screes, and banks. Fully hardy. Needs sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in spring or fall or by softwood cuttings in early summer.

S. ‘Bressingham’, syn. *S. ‘Bressingham Hybrid’*. Loose, mat-forming perennial. H 3in (8cm), S 4in (10cm). Has small, narrowly ovate leaves. Flattish, deep vibrant pink flowers are borne in clustered heads in summer. Good for a trough. Z4–9 **S. ‘Bressingham Hybrid’**. See *S. ‘Bressingham’*.

S. caespitosa illus. p.364. **S. ocymoides** (Tumbling tea) illus. p.364. **S. officinalis ‘Rubra Plena’** (Double

soapwort). Upright perennial. H to 3ft (1m), S 1ft (30cm). Has ovate, rough, mid-green leaves on erect stems. Clusters of ragged, double, red flowers are produced on upper part of flower stems in summer. Z2–8 **S. x olivana** illus. p.362.

SARCOCAPNOS

PAPAVERACEAE

Genus of spring-flowering dwarf annuals or perennials, useful for rock gardens. Frost hardy. Prefers a position in sun and well-drained, alkaline soil. Propagate by seed in spring.

S. enneaphylla. Loose, upright perennial. H and S 6in (15cm). Slender, much-branched stems bear small, divided, glaucous green leaves with ovate to elliptic leaflets. In spring, small, spurred, yellowish-white, purple-tipped flowers, are borne in short racemes. Protect from winter wet. Z9–11

SARCOCOCCA

Christmas box, Sweet box

BUXACEAE

Genus of evergreen shrubs, grown for their foliage, fragrant, winter flowers, and spherical fruits. Flowers are tiny—the only conspicuous part being the anthers. Useful for cutting in winter. Fully to frost hardy. Grow in sun or shade and fertile, not too dry soil. Propagate by semiripe cuttings in summer or by seed in fall.

S. confusa (illus. p.142). Evergreen, bushy, dense shrub. H and S 3ft (1m). Leaves are small, ovate, taper-pointed, glossy, and dark green. Bears tiny, white flowers in winter, then black fruits. Z6–9

S. hookeriana. Evergreen, upright, dense, suckering shrub. H 5ft (1.5m), S 6ft (2m). Forms clumps of narrowly oblong, pointed, dark green leaves and bears tiny, white flowers in the leaf axils during winter. Fruits are black. Z6–8.

var. digyna illus. p.164. **var. digyna ‘Purple Stem’** has young shoots flushed dark purple-pink, and pink-tinged flowers. **var. humilis** (syn. *S. humilis*) illus. p.164.

S. humilis. See *S. hookeriana* var. *humilis*. **S. ruscifolia**. Evergreen, upright, arching shrub. H and S 3ft (1m). Has ovate, glossy, dark green leaves and, in winter, creamy-white flowers, then red fruits. Z7–9. **var. chinensis** has narrower leaves. **var. chinensis ‘Dragon Gate’** has narrow, pointed, shining green leaves.

SARMIENTA

GESNERIACEAE

Genus of one species of evergreen, woody-stemmed, scrambling or trailing perennial. Suits hanging baskets. Frost tender. Likes partial shade and humus-rich soil that does not dry out. Propagate by seed in spring or by stem cuttings in summer or fall.

S. repens, syn. *S. scandens*. Evergreen, slender-stemmed, scrambling perennial. H and S 2ft (60cm) or more. Tips of ovate leaves each have 3–5 teeth. In summer, produces small, tubular, coral-pink flowers, each narrowed at the base and toward the mouth, which has 5 deeper pink lobes. Z10–11 (min. 41°F/5°C) **S. scandens**. See *S. repens*.

SARRACENIA

Pitcher plant

SARRACENIACEAE

Genus of insectivorous perennials, some of which are evergreen, with pitchers formed from modified leaves with hooded tops. Fully hardy to frost hardy. Grow in sun or partial shade and in peat and moss. Keep very wet, except in winter, when drier conditions are needed. Propagate by seed in spring.

S. flava (Yellow pitcher plant) illus. p.445. **S. purpurea** (Common pitcher plant, Huntsman’s cup) illus. p.439.

SASA

POACEAE/GRAMINEAE

See also GRASSES, BAMBOOS, RUSHES, and SEDGES.

S. albomarginata. See *S. veitchii*. **S. palmata**. Evergreen, spreading bamboo. H 6ft (2m), S indefinite. A fine foliage plant, it has very broad, rich green leaves, to 16in (40cm) long. Hollow, purple-streaked stems have one branch at each node. Z7–9 **S. veitchii**, syn. *S. albomarginata*, illus. p.284.

SASSAFRAS

LAURACEAE

Genus of deciduous trees grown for their aromatic foliage; flowers are inconspicuous. Fully hardy. Needs sun or light shade and deep, fertile, well-drained, preferably acidic soil. Propagate by seed or suckers in fall, or by root cuttings in winter. **S. albidum** illus. p.64.

SATUREJA

LAMIACEAE/LABIATAE

Genus of summer-flowering annuals, semievergreen perennials and subshrubs, grown for their highly aromatic leaves and attractive flowers. Useful for rock gardens and dry banks. Fully hardy to frost hardy. Needs sun and well-drained soil. Propagate by seed in winter or spring, or by softwood cuttings in summer.

S. montana (Winter savory). Upright, semievergreen perennial or subshrub. H 1ft (30cm), S 8in (20cm) or more. Leaves are linear to ovate, aromatic and green or grayish-green. Loose whorls of tubular, 2-lipped, lavender flowers are borne in summer. Z6–8. **‘Prostrate White’**, H 3–6in (7–15cm), has a prostrate habit and white flowers.

SAUROMATUM

ARACEAE

Genus of spring-flowering, tuberous perennials with tubular spathes that expand into waved, twisted blades. Tubers will flower without soil or moisture, and before the leaves emerge. Frost tender. Requires a sheltered, partially shaded position and humus-rich, well-drained soil. Water well throughout summer. Dry off or lift when dormant in winter. Propagate by offsets in spring.

S. guttatum. See *S. venosum*. **S. venosum**, syn. *S. guttatum* (Monarch-of-the-East, Voodoo lily), illus. p.403.

SAURURUS

SAURURACEAE

Genus of deciduous, perennial, bog, and marginal water plants, grown for their foliage. Fully hardy. Prefers full sun, but tolerates some shade. Remove faded leaves and divide plants as required to maintain vigour. Propagate by division in spring. **S. cernuus** (Lizard’s tail) illus. p.435.

SAXEGOTHAEA

PODOCARPACEAE

See also CONIFERS. **S. conspicua** (Prince Albert’s yew). Conifer that is conical in mild areas, more bushy in cold districts. H 15–50ft (5–15m), S 4–5m (12–15ft). Needlelike, flattened, dark green leaves develop in whorls at ends of shoots. Produces globose, fleshy, glaucous green cones. Z8–10

SAXIFRAGA

Saxifrage

SAXIFRAGACEAE

Genus of often rosetted perennials, most of which are evergreen or semievergreen, biennials, and few annuals. Grown for their flowers and attractive foliage. Excellent in rock gardens, raised beds, and alpine houses. Fully hardy to frost tender. Propagate by seed in fall or by rooted offsets in winter. For cultivation, saxifrages may be grouped as follows: 1—Needs moist soil and protection from midday sun. 2—Needs partially shaded, well-drained soil. Good among rocks and screes. 3—Thrives in well-drained rock pockets, troughs, alpine-house pans, etc, shaded from midday sun. Must never be dry at roots. Most form tight cushions and flower in early spring, flower stems being barely visible above leaves. 4—Needs full sun and well-drained, alkaline soil. Suits rock pockets. Most have hard leaves encrusted in lime. **S. aizoides** illus. p.359; cultivation group 1.

S. x anglica ‘Cranbourne’, syn. *S. ‘Cranbourne’*. Evergreen, cushion-forming perennial. H and S 5in (12cm). In early spring, bears solitary, cup-shaped, bright purplish-lilac flowers on short stems, just above tight rosettes of linear, green leaves. Flower stems are longer if plant is grown in an alpine house. Cultivation group 3. Z5–9

S. x apiculata ‘Gregor Mendel’, syn. *S. ‘Gregor Mendel’*, illus. p.357; cultivation group 2.

S. ‘Arco’. See. *S. x arco-valleyi ‘Arco’*. **S. x arco-valleyi ‘Arco’**, syn. *S. ‘Arco’*. Evergreen perennial forming a tight cushion. H and S 4in (10cm). In early spring, produces upturned, cup-shaped to flattish, pale lilac flowers, almost resting on tight rosettes of oblong to linear leaves. Cultivation group 3. Z5–9

S. ‘Bob Hawkins’. Evergreen perennial with a loose rosette of leaves. H 1–2in (2.5–5cm), S 6in (15cm). In summer, bears small, upturned, rounded, greenish-white flowers on 2in (5cm) stems. Ovate, green leaves are white-splashed. Cultivation group 1. Z5–9